

has quickly become a reality and is predicted to disrupt the mature gaming industry once again.

VLSI

As the size of transistors kept on reducing researchers began to toy with the idea of having more number of transistors on a single chip to create powerful integrated circuits. This process is exactly what VLSI or Very-Large-Scale-Integration is all about. Today millions (nay billions) of transistors can be combined into a single chip. The cost and performance benefits of integrated circuits is what makes computing so ubiquitous and easily accessible. The first rudimentary idea for integrated circuits can be traced back to German engineer Werner Jacobi in 1949 when he filed a patent for a device that showed five transistors on a single substrate. However the idea really took off when Jack Kilby of Texas Instruments filed his own patent about 10 years later. (Check out the entry on integrated circuits for more info). The first breakthroughs in VLSI can be traced back to the '80s though when the number of transistors reached the thousands. Moore's Law anyone?

